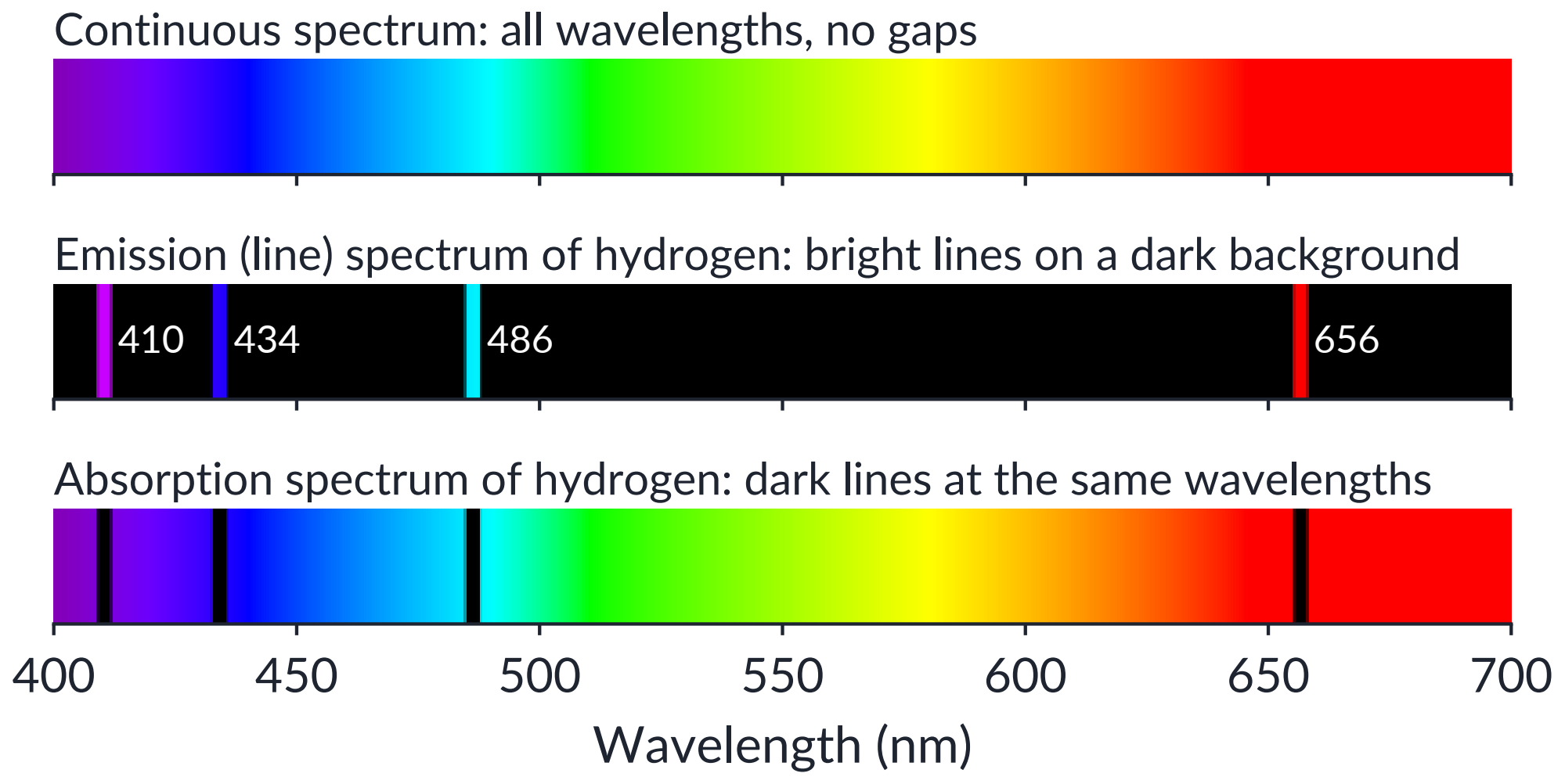
Continuous spectrum: all wavelengths, no gaps
Emission (line) spectrum of hydrogen: bright lines on a dark background
410
434
486
656
Absorption spectrum of hydrogen: dark lines at the same wavelengths
400
450
500
550
600
650
700
Wavelength (nm)